



MBA (Trimester-II) Regular Examination February 2026

Roll no.....

Name of the Course and semester: Trimester- II
Name of the Paper: Retail and E-commerce Management
Paper Code: MBA-205
Time: 3 hour

Maximum Marks: 100

Note:

- (i) This question paper contains two Sections-Section A and B
- (ii) Both Sections are compulsory
- (iii) Answer any two sub questions from a, b & c in each main question of Section A. Each sub question carries 10 marks.
- (iv) Section B, consisting of a case study, is compulsory. It is of 40 Marks.

Section A

- Q1. (2X10=20 Marks)
- a. What are the different types of retail formats? Which retail format is most suitable for selling fresh vegetables near residential areas? Justify your answer. CO-1 & CO-3
 - b. Differentiate traditional retail and modern retail with examples. Do you think that modern retail is a threat to traditional retail? CO-2
 - c. Discuss the impact of government FDI policies on retail growth. CO-2
- Q2. (2X10=20 Marks)
- a. How can omni-channel strategy concepts be significant to improve a local retailer's performance? CO-3
 - b. Analyze the advantages and limitations of brick-and-mortar vs pure-play models. CO-4
 - c. What are the factors that influence impulsive buying behavior in modern retailing? CO-3
- Q3. (2X10=20 Marks)
- a. Do you think store layout is important for high sales? Justify your answer. CO-2
 - b. What is the difference between Forced Path Layout and Free Flow Layout? Discuss with examples. CO-1
 - c. Develop a retail plan for a leather bag manufacturer. The firm has a limited budget and wants to target tier-II cities in the initial phase. CO-6

Section B

- Q4. Case Study (4 x 10= 40 Marks)

Choosing the Right Retail Format in a Digital Age

Retail businesses today face a strategic dilemma: whether to operate through traditional physical stores, digital-only platforms, or a hybrid format. This decision affects cost structure, customer experience, scalability, and long-term competitiveness. Consider the strategic journeys of Walmart, Amazon, and Reliance Retail, which illustrate different retail format approaches.

For decades, Walmart dominated through its brick-and-mortar model, focusing on physical presence, supply chain efficiency, and low pricing. Its stores allowed customers to see, touch, and instantly purchase products, building trust and loyalty, especially in regions where digital adoption



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was slower. However, rising online competition and changing consumer expectations pushed Walmart to invest heavily in e-commerce and omni-channel services such as click-and-collect.

In contrast, Amazon began as a pure-play online retailer with no physical stores. Its model relied on digital convenience, wide assortment, personalized recommendations, and logistics excellence. Without store overhead costs, it scaled rapidly across markets. Yet, Amazon later entered physical retail through smart stores and acquisitions, recognizing that some consumers still value tactile shopping experiences and immediate product access.

Meanwhile, Reliance Retail adopted a hybrid approach from early stages. It expanded aggressively through supermarkets, electronics outlets, and fashion stores while simultaneously building strong digital platforms and integrating them with local kirana shops. This brick-and-click model allowed it to leverage physical reach and digital convenience, especially in diverse markets like India where consumer preferences vary widely across regions and income segments.

The case highlights that no single retail format is universally superior. Brick-and-mortar stores excel in experiential shopping and trust building. Pure-play models offer scalability, data analytics, and cost efficiency. Hybrid models attempt to combine the strengths of both but require high investment and strong integration capabilities. Retailers must align format choice with target market behavior, infrastructure readiness, product type, and competitive dynamics.

Ultimately, retail success depends not just on format selection but on how effectively firms integrate technology, logistics, and customer experience into their strategic model.

Answer the following questions:

Q.-1-Analyze the advantages and limitations of brick-and-mortar, pure-play, and hybrid retail formats based on the case. **CO-4**

Q.-2-If you were advising a new retail startup, which format would you recommend and why? **CO-5**

Q.3- Identify which retail format is most suitable for rural markets and justify your answer briefly. **CO-3**

Q.4-State two factors that influenced retailers in the case to shift from a single-format strategy to a hybrid model. **CO-2**